nsconv Operator Guide

Install, configure and run the Huawei NetStream converter for Illumio FlowLink.

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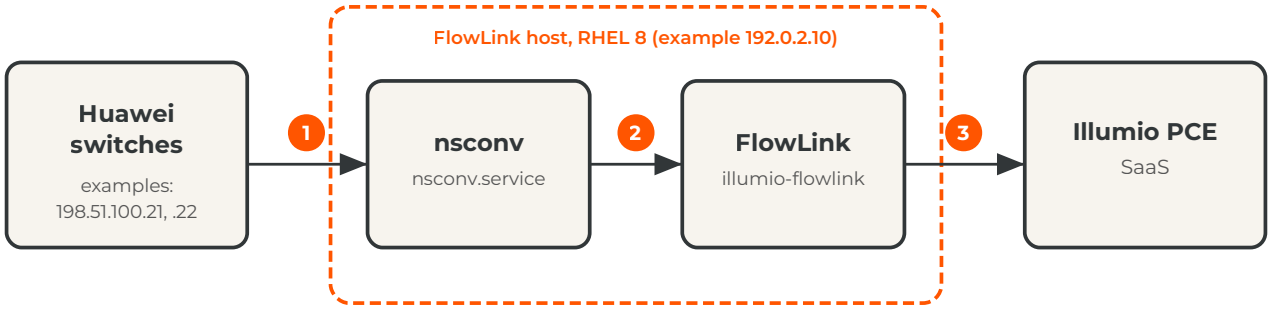
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What nsconv does

Huawei switches and routers export their flows as **NetStream**: NetFlow v5, NetFlow v9 or IPFIX with Huawei-specific details (a modified v5 version field, private fields, uptime-relative timestamps, long template refresh intervals, sampling rates that are often not reported). Illumio FlowLink reads NetFlow v5, v7, v9, IPFIX and sFlow[1]. **nsconv** sits between the two: it receives NetStream, decodes it with the Huawei details handled, and sends every flow again as clean, standard IPFIX (default), NetFlow v9 or NetFlow v5 to FlowLink.

Use nsconv when Huawei devices must feed Illumio FlowLink. It runs as a small service (`nsconv.service`) on the FlowLink host, or on its own host. One binary, `nsconvctl`, runs the service and is also the command-line tool and the terminal UI.

DATA FLOW, CO-LOCATED DEPLOYMENT (DEFAULT)



1 NetStream v5 / v9 / IPFIX, UDP to port 9996 of the host (allow-list of switch IPs)
2 Clean IPFIX to 127.0.0.1:4739, sent from each switch's own IP and port
3 FlowLink sends the flow summaries to the PCE (its usual connection)

What happens to each flow

- **Accepted only from allowed switches.** Datagrams from sources outside the input's allow list are dropped and counted. An empty list drops everything.
- **Decoded with the Huawei details handled**: v5 with the direction bit, v9 and IPFIX templates per switch, Line-card Source IDs, IPFIX uptime-relative times, repeated fields. Learned templates are saved, so a restart does not wait for the switch's next template refresh.
- **Re-sent with one fixed, standard template** (IANA fields only, no padding, no vendor fields), absolute timestamps, the byte count, and the sampling rate in every record. Counters are not scaled: FlowLink receives the raw numbers and the rate.
- **Exporter identity kept.** By default each switch's flows leave nsconv from that switch's own IP address and port, so FlowLink still sees every switch as its own sender.
- **Clock correction.** If a switch clock is off by more than 5 minutes (time zone, missing NTP), flow times are shifted to the receive time so FlowLink does not discard them.
- **Everything is counted.** Every dropped or changed flow has a named counter in `nsconvctl status`, the TUI and the journal.

Deployment modes

MODE	WHERE NSCONV RUNS	OUTPUT SETTING	FLOWLINK `REMOTE_ADDRS`
Co-located (recommended)	On the FlowLink host	`source_address = "exporter"` (default), target `127.0.0.1:4739`	The switch IPs
Co-located, one sender	On the FlowLink host	`source_address = "local"`	`127.0.0.1`
Standalone, same L2 segment	Own host, same subnet as FlowLink	`source_address = "exporter"`, target = FlowLink host	The switch IPs
Standalone, routed	Own host, routers in between	`source_address = "local"`, target = FlowLink host	The nsconv host IP

With `exporter` the datagrams carry the switch addresses as their source. That works on the same host and on the same Layer 2 segment. When routers sit between nsconv and FlowLink, use `local`: routers with anti-spoofing filters drop packets whose source address does not belong to the sending network.

SOURCES

1. Illumio FlowLink 2.0 — Ingested flow types — product-docs-repo.illumio.com/Tech-Docs/Core/26.1/Install-Upgrade-Admin/out/en/flowlink-2-0-0-configuration-and-usage/configure-flowlink/ingested-flow-types.html
2. Huawei IP Encyclopedia — NetStream — info.support.huawei.com/info-finder/encyclopedia/en/NetStream.html

Requirements

ITEM	REQUIREMENT
Operating system	RHEL, Rocky Linux or AlmaLinux 8 or 9, x86_64 (aarch64 builds are also published). systemd, SELinux enforcing and firewalld are supported as shipped. This release was tested end to end on Rocky Linux 8.10.
Illumio FlowLink	1.4.0 or later; **2.0.1 recommended** (it reports byte counts from all input sources)[1,2].
Access	root (or sudo) to install and to change the configuration; root or group `nsconv` to read the status.
Resources	Two threads with one input, a few MB of memory (hard limit 128 MB in the unit), no disk writes on the data path.

Ports

PORT	DIRECTION	USED BY
UDP 9996 (default, `input.<name>.listen`)	Switches → nsconv	NetStream from the switches. Open it for the switch addresses only.
UDP 4739 (default, `output.<name>.target`)	nsconv → FlowLink	FlowLink's IPFIX consumer. On the same host this is loopback traffic, which firewalld accepts.
`/run/nsconv/ctl.sock`	Local only	Control socket for `nsconvctl` and the TUI. No network port.

FlowLink has no default ports: each consumer listens on the port its configuration names[3]. nsconv must never listen on a port that FlowLink uses.

Release files (0.1.0-rc1)

The files are in the `releases/0.1.0-rc1/` folder of the public repository `github.com/roschereric/netstream-converter`.

FILE	USE
`nsconv-0.1.0~rc1-1.x86_64.rpm`, `nsconv-0.1.0~rc1-1.aarch64.rpm`	RPM package (normal route)
`nsconvctl-0.1.0-rc1-x86_64-linux`, `nsconvctl-0.1.0-rc1-aarch64-linux`	Static binary for `nsconvctl install`, or for `decode` / `replay` on any Linux host
`SHA256SUMS`	Checksums of all files
`nsconv-0.1.0-rc1.cdx.json`	Software bill of materials (CycloneDX)

This test release is not signed. Check the downloaded files against `SHA256SUMS` before installing:

INSTALL HOST

```
sha256sum -c SHA256SUMS --ignore-missing
```

SOURCES

1. FlowLink 1.4.0 — Resolved and known issues — product-docs-repo.illumio.com/Tech-Docs/Core/24.5/Release-Notes/out/en/illumio-flowlink-release-notes-for-release-1-4-0/resolved-and-known-issues-in-flowlink-1-4-0.html
2. FlowLink 2.0.1 — What's new — product-docs-repo.illumio.com/Tech-Docs/Core/26.1/Release-Notes/out/en/flowlink-release-notes/illumio-flowlink-release-notes-2-0-1/what-s-new-in-flowlink-2-0-1.html
3. FlowLink 2.0 — Ingested flow types — product-docs-repo.illumio.com/Tech-Docs/Core/26.1/Install-Upgrade-Admin/out/en/flowlink-2-0-0-configuration-and-usage/configure-flowlink/ingested-flow-types.html

Install

OPTION A RPM package (recommended)

INSTALL HOST (ROOT)

```
rpm -ivh nsconv-0.1.0~rc1-1.x86_64.rpm
```

The package creates the system user and group `nsconv` and installs these files. It does **not** enable or start the service and does not open any firewall port.

FILE	CONTENT
`/usr/bin/nsconvctl`	The binary (service, CLI and TUI)
`/usr/lib/systemd/system/nsconv.service`	Hardened systemd unit
`/etc/nsconv/nsconv.toml`	Configuration (root:nsconv 0640, kept on upgrade)
`/usr/lib/sysctl.d/90-nsconv.conf`	`net.core.rmem_max = 8388608`, applied at install time unless the host already uses a larger value
`/usr/share/doc/nsconv/README.md`	Short operator README

OPTION B Static binary with nsconvctl install

For hosts where you prefer not to install an RPM. `--dry-run` prints every step first:

INSTALL HOST (ROOT)

```
chmod 0755 nsconvctl-0.1.0-rc1-x86_64-linux
./nsconvctl-0.1.0-rc1-x86_64-linux install --dry-run
./nsconvctl-0.1.0-rc1-x86_64-linux install
```

It copies the binary to `/usr/local/bin/nsconvctl`, creates the `nsconv` user and group, writes the unit to `/etc/systemd/system/nsconv.service` and the default configuration to `/etc/nsconv/nsconv.toml` (only if absent), and prints the `firewall-cmd` lines to run. `--enable` and `--now` also enable and start the service. The binary install does not ship the sysctl file; raise the kernel receive buffer limit yourself:

INSTALL HOST (ROOT)

```
echo 'net.core.rmem_max = 8388608' > /etc/sysctl.d/90-nsconv.conf
sysctl -w net.core.rmem_max=8388608
```

Firewall (firewalld)

Open the input port only for the switches, in a dedicated zone. The zone name and the network are examples:

INSTALL HOST (ROOT)

```
firewall-cmd --permanent --new-zone=nsconv-exporters
firewall-cmd --permanent --zone=nsconv-exporters --add-source=198.51.100.0/24
firewall-cmd --permanent --zone=nsconv-exporters --add-port=9996/udp
firewall-cmd --reload
```

When FlowLink runs on the same host and only nsconv should feed it, keep FlowLink's port (4739) closed to the network. Traffic from nsconv to FlowLink stays on loopback.

SELinux

No policy module is needed. A binary in `/usr/bin` or `/usr/local/bin` has the `bin_t` label and systemd runs it in the `unconfined_service_t` domain[2]. If you copy the binary by hand from another directory, restore its label; a wrong label shows as status `203/EXEC` in `systemctl status nsconv`:

INSTALL HOST (ROOT)

```
restorecon -v /usr/local/bin/nsconvctl
```

SOURCES

1. firewalld — Zones — firewalld.org/documentation/zone/
2. unconfined_service_selinux(8) — www.mankier.com/8/unconfined_service_selinux
3. Red Hat Enterprise Linux 8 — Using SELinux — docs.redhat.com/en/documentation/red_hat_enterprise_linux/8/html/using_selinux/index

Configure nsconv

The configuration is one TOML file, `/etc/nsconv/nsconv.toml`, with one `[[input]]` (where the switches send) and one or more `[[output]]` (where the flows go). The shipped file has one input named `huawei` and one output named `flowlink`; keys are addressed as `input.huawei.allow`, `output.flowlink.target` and so on. The full key list is in the Reference section.

`nsconvctl config set` changes one value, keeps the comments in the file, validates the result, writes it and asks the running service to reload. An invalid value is refused and the file stays untouched.

FIRST START Three settings, then start

1

Allow the switches

Single IPs or CIDRs. Until this is set, every datagram is dropped.

ROOT

```
nsconvctl config set input.huawei.allow '["198.51.100.0/24"]'
```

2

Point the output at FlowLink

The default is FlowLink's IPFIX consumer on the same host. For a FlowLink on another host use its address, for example `192.0.2.10:4739`.

ROOT

```
nsconvctl config set output.flowlink.target 127.0.0.1:4739
```

3

Start the service and check it

Health `ok` and growing `flows_out` mean flows are leaving nsconv.

ROOT

```
systemctl enable --now nsconv
nsconvctl status
```

Common changes

GOAL	COMMAND (ROOT)
Several switch networks	`nsconvctl config set input.huawei.allow '["198.51.100.0/24", "203.0.113.5"]'`
Switches sample at 1:2048 but do not report it	`nsconvctl config set input.huawei.sampling_rate 2048`
One switch samples differently	`nsconvctl config set input.huawei.sampling_override '{ "198.51.100.21" = 2048 }'`
Send NetFlow v9 instead of IPFIX	`nsconvctl config set output.flowlink.protocol netflow9`
Keep one copy of transit traffic	`nsconvctl config set convert.direction ingress`
Accept IPv6 switches too	`nsconvctl config set input.huawei.listen '[::]:9996'`, then `systemctl restart nsconv`

Counters are never scaled: nsconv forwards the raw numbers plus the rate. Precedence per switch: `sampling_override`, the rate the switch reports, then `sampling_rate` (default 1000).

Reload or restart

`config set` reloads by itself. After editing the file by hand, or with `nsconvctl config edit` (`$EDITOR` on a validated copy), run `nsconvctl reload`. Changing an input's listen address or receive buffer, adding or removing an input, or the `[daemon]` section needs `systemctl restart nsconv`; the reload answer says *restart required*. `nsconvctl config check` validates a file without applying it.

A second output

Outputs are added in the file. Example: also send NetFlow v9 to a second collector (name and address are examples):

/ETC/NSCONV/NSCONV.TOML

```
[[output]]
name = "collector2"
protocol = "netflow9"
target = "192.0.2.20:2055"
source_address = "local"
```

SOURCES

1. nsconv 0.1.0-rc1 — shipped configuration and nsconvctl config --help — github.com/roschereric/netstream-converter

Configure FlowLink

FlowLink reads `/etc/illumio-flowlink/config.yaml`[1]. Add one consumer for nsconv: an `ipfix` parser with a `udp` connector on the port of `output.flowlink.target`. `remote_addrs` is optional, takes single IP addresses (no CIDR) as a string or a list, and limits the consumer to those sources[2,3].

Co-located, source_address = "exporter" (default)

FlowLink sees the switches as senders, so `remote_addrs` lists the switch IPs (examples):

/ETC/ILLUMIO-FLOWLINK/CONFIG.YAML

```
consumers:
  - name: nsconv-ipfix
    parser:
      type: ipfix
    connectors:
      - type: udp
        properties:
          ports: '4739'
          remote_addrs: '198.51.100.21,198.51.100.22'
```

source_address = "local"

FlowLink sees nsconv as the only sender. Co-located: `remote_addrs: '127.0.0.1'`. Standalone: the nsconv host's IP address, for example `remote_addrs: '192.0.2.30'`.

NetFlow v9 or v5 output

With `protocol = "netflow9"` or `"netflow5"` use a consumer with `parser: type: netflow` on its own port (for example 2055) and set `output.flowlink.target` to that port. Keep one protocol per consumer and port.

Apply the change by restarting FlowLink[1]:

FLOWLINK HOST (ROOT)

```
systemctl stop illumio-flowlink
systemctl start illumio-flowlink
```

AFTER A FLOWLINK RESTART

nsconv resends its templates every 20 seconds (`template_refresh_secs`). A collector that starts after nsconv decodes the flows from the next template refresh on.

Which NetStream version on the switch

SWITCH TRAFFIC	SWITCH EXPORT	NSCONV OUTPUT
IPv4 only	NetFlow v5 is enough; v9 also works	`ipfix` (default)
IPv4 and IPv6	NetFlow v9 (or IPFIX), plus the `ipv6 netstream` lines; NetStream v5 cannot carry IPv6	`ipfix` or `netflow9`; never `netflow5`

Set `input.huawei.sampling_rate` (or `sampling_override` per switch) to the rate configured on the switches; v5 switches usually do not report it.

SOURCES

1. FlowLink 2.0 — Deploy FlowLink as a Linux service — product-docs-repo.illumio.com/Tech-Docs/Core/26.1/Install-Upgrade-Admin/out/en/flowlink-2-0-0-configuration-and-usage/configure-flowlink/deploy-flowlink-as-a-linux-service.html
2. FlowLink 2.0 — Ingested flow types — product-docs-repo.illumio.com/Tech-Docs/Core/26.1/Install-Upgrade-Admin/out/en/flowlink-2-0-0-configuration-and-usage/configure-flowlink/ingested-flow-types.html
3. FlowLink 2.0 — Ingested flow examples — product-docs-repo.illumio.com/Tech-Docs/Core/26.1/Install-Upgrade-Admin/out/en/flowlink-2-0-0-configuration-and-usage/configure-flowlink/ingested-flow-examples.html

Configure the Huawei switches

DEVICE-SIDE COMMANDS: VERIFY ON YOUR VRP RELEASE

The lines below are run on the Huawei device, not on the Linux host. Command syntax differs between product families and VRP releases; check each line against the command reference of your model and release before applying it.

Recommendations for every family: send to the nsconv host (example `192.0.2.10`) on UDP 9996; refresh templates every minute (`template timeout-rate 1`); age flows quickly (`timeout active 1`, `timeout inactive 15`), otherwise long flows reach FlowLink up to 30 minutes late; use 32-bit interface indexes (`index-switch 32`); sample inbound only, so transit traffic is not reported twice; keep the device clock on NTP with the correct time zone. The default active timeout is 30 minutes and the default template refresh is 30 minutes[1]. Example values: switch address `198.51.100.21`, interfaces `GigabitEthernet0/0/1` and `10GE1/0/1`, record name `illumio-rec`, slot 3.

S-series / AR (V200 style): NetFlow v9 original flows

HUAWEI DEVICE — VERIFY ON YOUR VRP RELEASE

```
ip netstream export version 9
ip netstream export source 198.51.100.21
ip netstream export host 192.0.2.10 9996
ip netstream export template timeout-rate 1
ip netstream export template option sampler
ip netstream export index-switch 32
ip netstream timeout active 1
ip netstream timeout inactive 15
#
interface GigabitEthernet0/0/1
 ip netstream sampler fix-packets 1000 inbound
 ip netstream inbound
```

For IPv4-only switches `export version 5` is also fine. On AR routers an unset sampler means 1:100 by default. Where IPv6 must be visible, add the matching `ipv6 netstream` lines (same keywords, as in the NetEngine example) and keep version 9.

CloudEngine (V200R019C10 syntax): NetFlow v9 flexible record

HUAWEI DEVICE — VERIFY ON YOUR VRP RELEASE

```
netstream export ip source 198.51.100.21
netstream export ip host 192.0.2.10 9996
netstream export ip version 9
netstream export ip index-switch 32
netstream export ip template timeout-rate 1
netstream timeout ip active 1
netstream timeout ip inactive 15
#
netstream record illumio-rec ip
 match ip source-address
 match ip destination-address
 match ip source-port
 match ip destination-port
 match ip protocol
 match ip tos
 collect counter bytes
 collect counter packets
 collect interface input
 collect interface output
#
interface 10GE1/0/1
 netstream record illumio-rec ip
 netstream inbound ip
```

Bind the record to the interface before enabling NetStream on it. Some releases write the refresh line as `netstream template ip timeout 1`.

NE40E / NetEngine 8000 (VRP8): IPFIX, distributed, inbound only

HUAWEI DEVICE — VERIFY ON YOUR VRP RELEASE

```
slot 3
 ip netstream sampler to slot self
 ipv6 netstream sampler to slot self
```

```
ip netstream timeout active 1
ip netstream timeout inactive 15
ip netstream export version ipfix
ip netstream export index-switch 32
ip netstream export template timeout-rate 1
ip netstream export template option sampler
ip netstream sampler fix-packets 1000 inbound
ip netstream export source 198.51.100.21
ip netstream export host 192.0.2.10 9996
```

```
ipv6 netstream timeout active 1
ipv6 netstream timeout inactive 15
ipv6 netstream export version ipfix
ipv6 netstream export index-switch 32
ipv6 netstream export template timeout-rate 1
ipv6 netstream sampler fix-packets 1000 inbound
ipv6 netstream export source 198.51.100.21
ipv6 netstream export host 192.0.2.10 9996
```

```
interface GigabitEthernet0/3/0
 ip netstream inbound
 ipv6 netstream inbound
```

To confirm what a switch really sends before or after the change, use the NetStream Capture Kit (link on the documentation home page) or `nsconvctl debug-capture` (Operate section).

SOURCES

1. Huawei IP Encyclopedia — NetStream — info.support.huawei.com/info-finder/encyclopedia/en/NetStream.html
2. Huawei CloudEngine 12800 V200R019C10 — NetStream configuration commands — support.huawei.com/enterprise/en/doc/EDOC1100138131/3a962da5/netstream-configuration-commands

Operate

Status

`nsconvctl status` shows health and its reasons, open alerts, inputs, counters (zero drop counters are hidden), one line per exporter session and one per output. `--exporter 198.51.100.21` narrows it to one switch, `--detail` adds the busiest interfaces and idle sessions, `--json` prints the full status as JSON. Every command ends with a machine-readable `NSCONV-RESULT` line and an exit code (Reference section). Excerpt from a lab run that replayed recorded Huawei captures on one host while no collector was listening:

NSCONVCTL STATUS (EXCERPT)

```
nsconv 0.1.0 · health degraded · up 3s · pid 59269
  ! output flowlink: Connection refused (os error 61) (1s ago)

alerts (5): silence one with `nsconvctl dismiss <id>`, all with `nsconvctl dismiss all`
  sampling-default:127.0.0.1:65009:0
      sampling rate not reported, using default 1000
  ...
counters
  COUNTER             VALUE
  datagrams_in        9
  bytes_in            3132
  flows_in            38
  flows_out           19
  datagrams_out       3
  send_errors         1
  restamped           38
  sampling_defaulted  32
  flows_lost_send     19
  ...
accounting: every datagram and flow is accounted for (0 flows waiting in open datagrams)

outputs (1)
  NAME      PROTOCOL  TARGET          SOURCE-ADDRESS  STREAMS  FLOWS  DATAGRAMS  ERRORS
  flowlink  ipfix     127.0.0.1:4739  local           1        19     3          1
  ! flowlink: last error Connection refused (os error 61) (1s ago)
NSCONV-RESULT schema=1 version=0.1.0 command=status code=1 status=warning health=degraded ...
```

The exporters table has one row per exporter session with the columns EXPORTER (switch IP and source port), SOURCE-ID, VER (`v5` , `v9` , `ipfix`), INPUT, SAMPLING (rate and its source: `override` , `reported` by the switch, or `default`), SKEW (switch clock minus host clock), RESTAMPED, FLOWS, NO-TPL, LAST SEEN and SEQ LOSS (loss estimated from the switch's sequence numbers).

Alerts

Conditions that need a look raise an alert with a stable id: `sampling-default` , `restamped` , `no-template` , `seq-gap` (sequence numbers show loss), `many-sessions` , `flowless-sessions` and `collector-down` (nothing listens on a local output target). Once you have checked one, silence it; it comes back if its value doubles or after it has been absent for 24 hours. Dismissing never changes the health.

ROOT OR GROUP NSCONV

```
nsconvctl dismiss sampling-default:198.51.100.21:40000:0
nsconvctl dismiss all
nsconvctl undismiss sampling-default:198.51.100.21:40000:0
```

Logs

nsconv logs to the journal; journald handles rotation. At `info` nothing is logged per datagram; repeated conditions are rate limited, and persistent ones (default sampling rate, clock skew, data without template) warn once per exporter every 6 hours.

ROOT OR GROUP NSCONV

```
nsconvctl logs -f                # follow (journalctl -u nsconv -f)
nsconvctl logs --since 2h
nsconvctl logs --recent 50       # last lines from the service's memory
nsconvctl config set log.level debug   # one line per event kind, rate limited (root)
nsconvctl config set log.level info
```

Capture one switch for analysis

`nsconvctl debug-capture 198.51.100.21` runs `tcpdump` (root) for up to 60 seconds or 2000 datagrams and writes the switch's raw NetStream datagrams to a pcap file; `--dry-run` prints the tcpdump command. `nsconvctl decode <file.pcap>` shows the flows nsconv reads from it, on any host.

Upgrade

RPM: `rpm -Uvh` with the new package, for example `rpm -Uvh nsconv-0.1.1-1.x86_64.rpm`. The upgrade keeps `/etc/nsconv/nsconv.toml` and the learned templates and restarts the service if it was running. Binary install: run `install --now` with the new binary.

Uninstall

RPM: `rpm -e nsconv` stops and disables the service and removes the files; the `nsconv` user, `/var/lib/nsconv` and a modified configuration (`nsconv.toml.rpmsave`) are kept. Binary install: `nsconvctl uninstall` , or `nsconvctl uninstall --purge` to also remove `/etc/nsconv` , `/var/lib/nsconv` and the user and group.

SOURCES

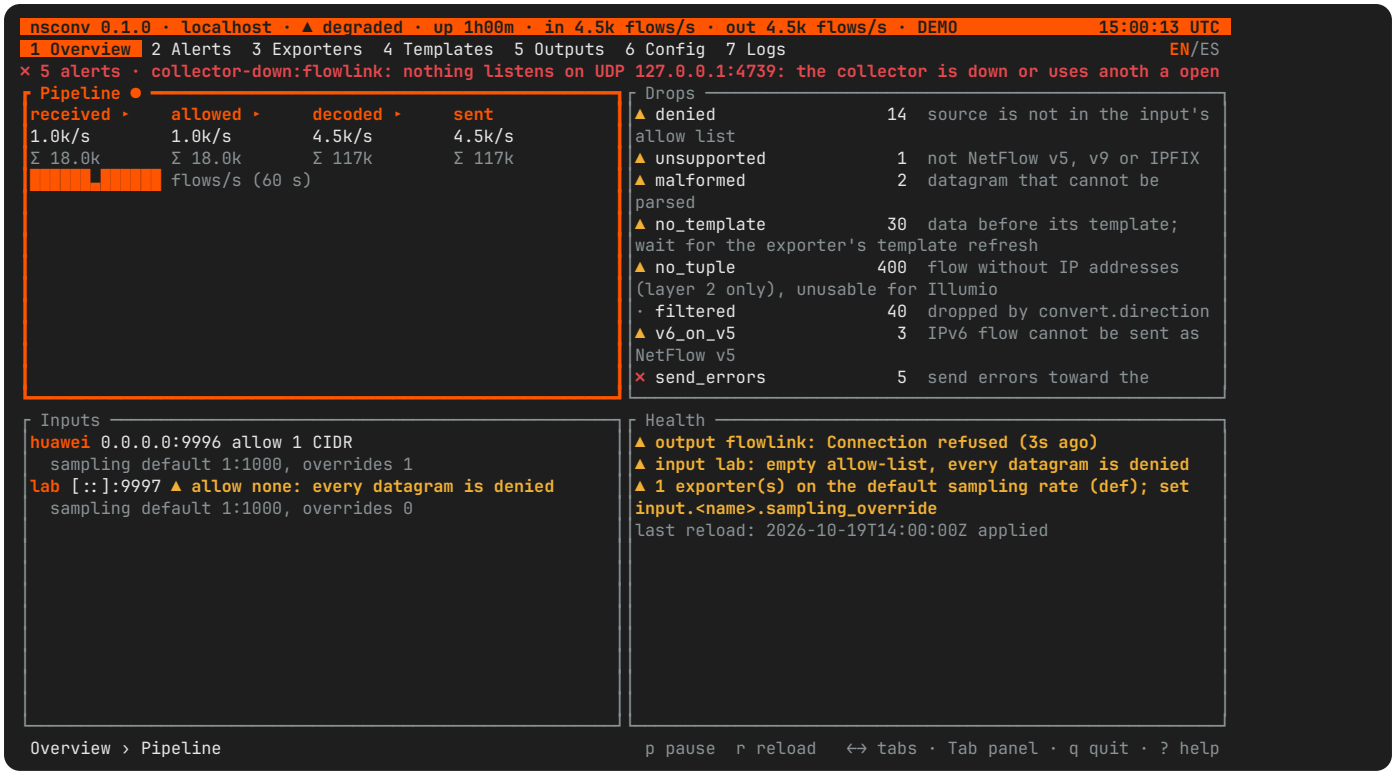
1. nsconv 0.1.0-rc1 — nsconvctl --help and status output — github.com/roschereric/netstream-converter

TUI tour

`nsconvctl tui` is a full-screen terminal view of the running service: the status refreshes every second. Run it as root (`sudo nsconvctl tui`) to edit the configuration in the Config tab; members of group `nsconv` get a read-only view. `--lang es` shows the explanations in Spanish, `--theme brand|terminal|light|mono` picks the colors, and `nsconvctl tui --demo` runs with demo data and no service, as in the screens below (demo data, example addresses).

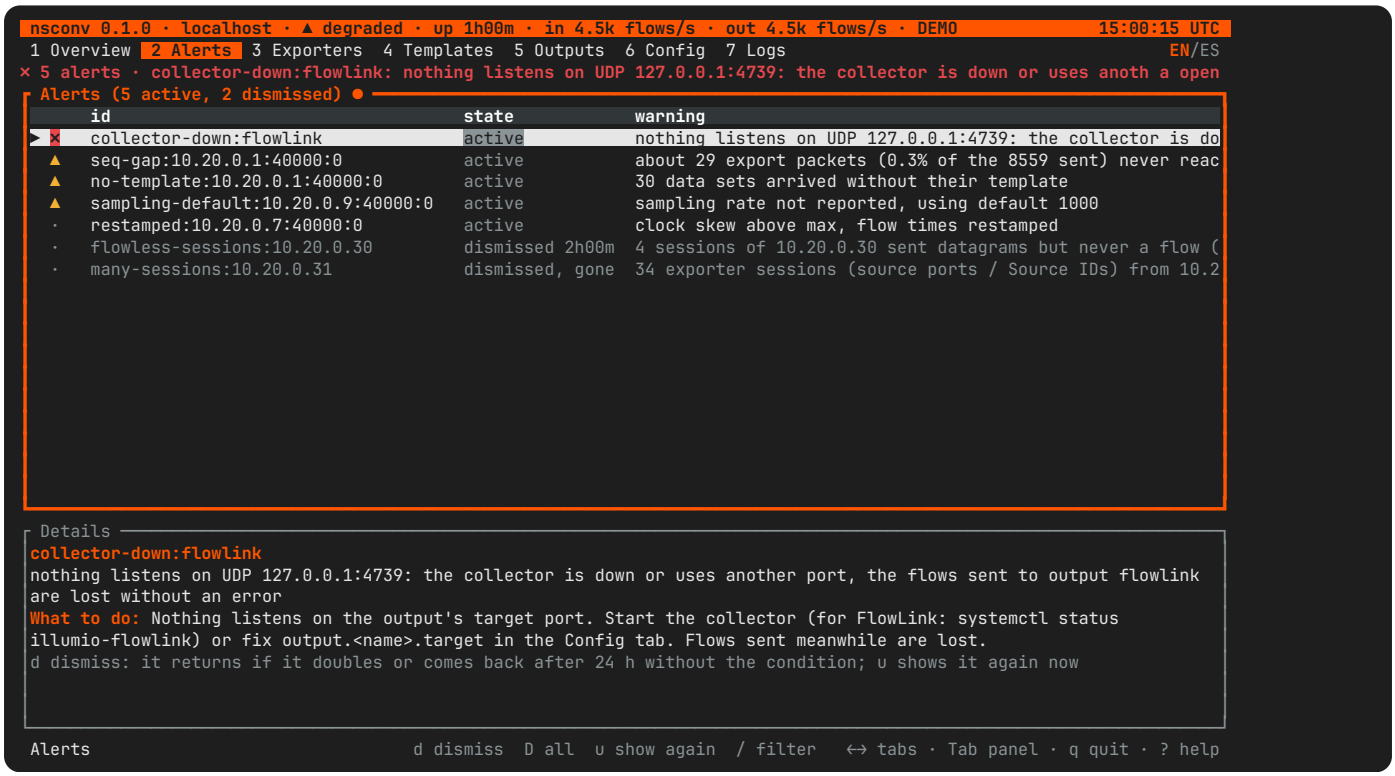
1 Overview

The pipeline from received to sent with rates, every non-zero drop counter with a one-line explanation, the inputs, and the health reasons with the next step.



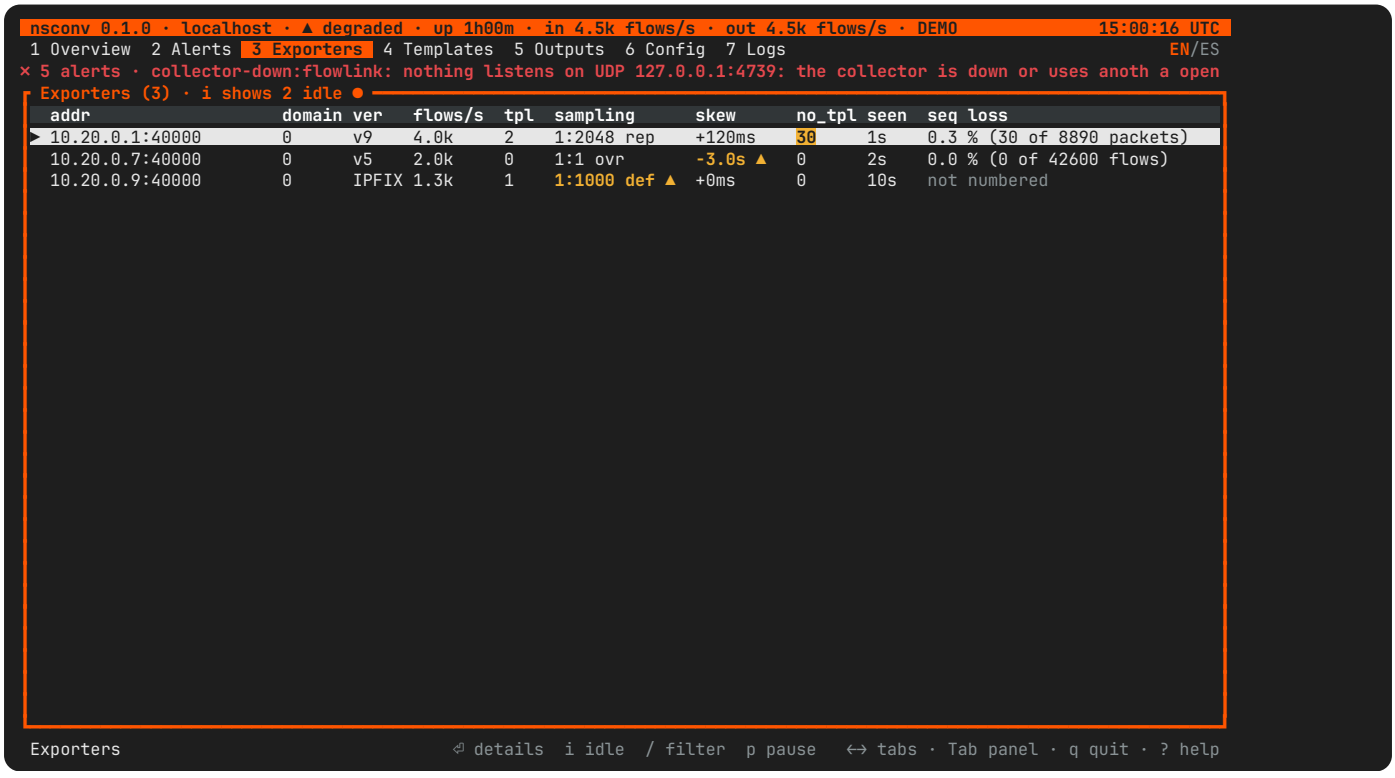
2 Alerts

Open and dismissed alerts with the advice for each; `d` dismisses the selected one.



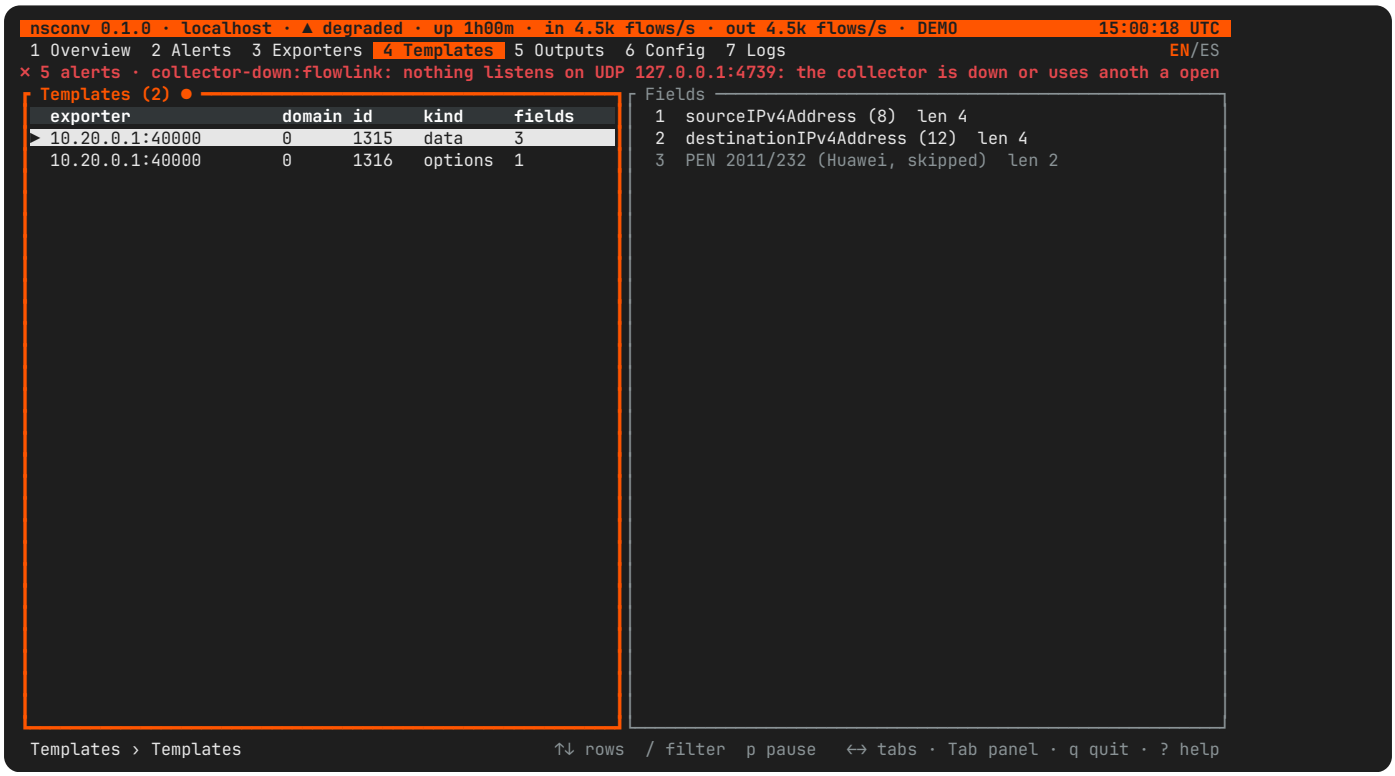
3 Exporters

One row per exporter session (switch IP and port, Source ID): version, rate and its source (`def` marks the default rate), clock skew, restamps, data without template, sequence loss. `Enter` shows the details with a hint for the main problem.



4 Templates

The templates learned from each switch and the ordered field list of the selected one.



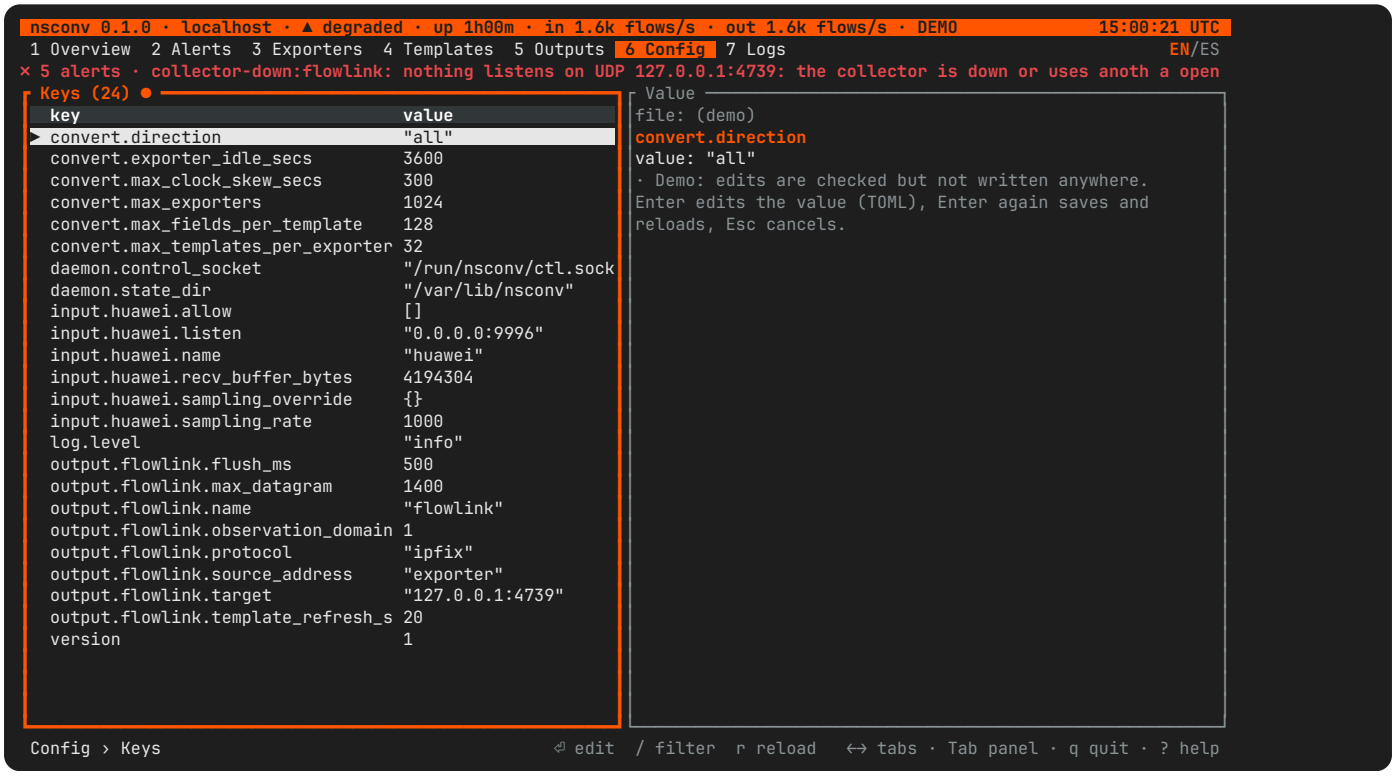
5 Outputs

Per output: protocol, target, streams, flows, datagrams, errors, the last error, and whether a local collector is listening.



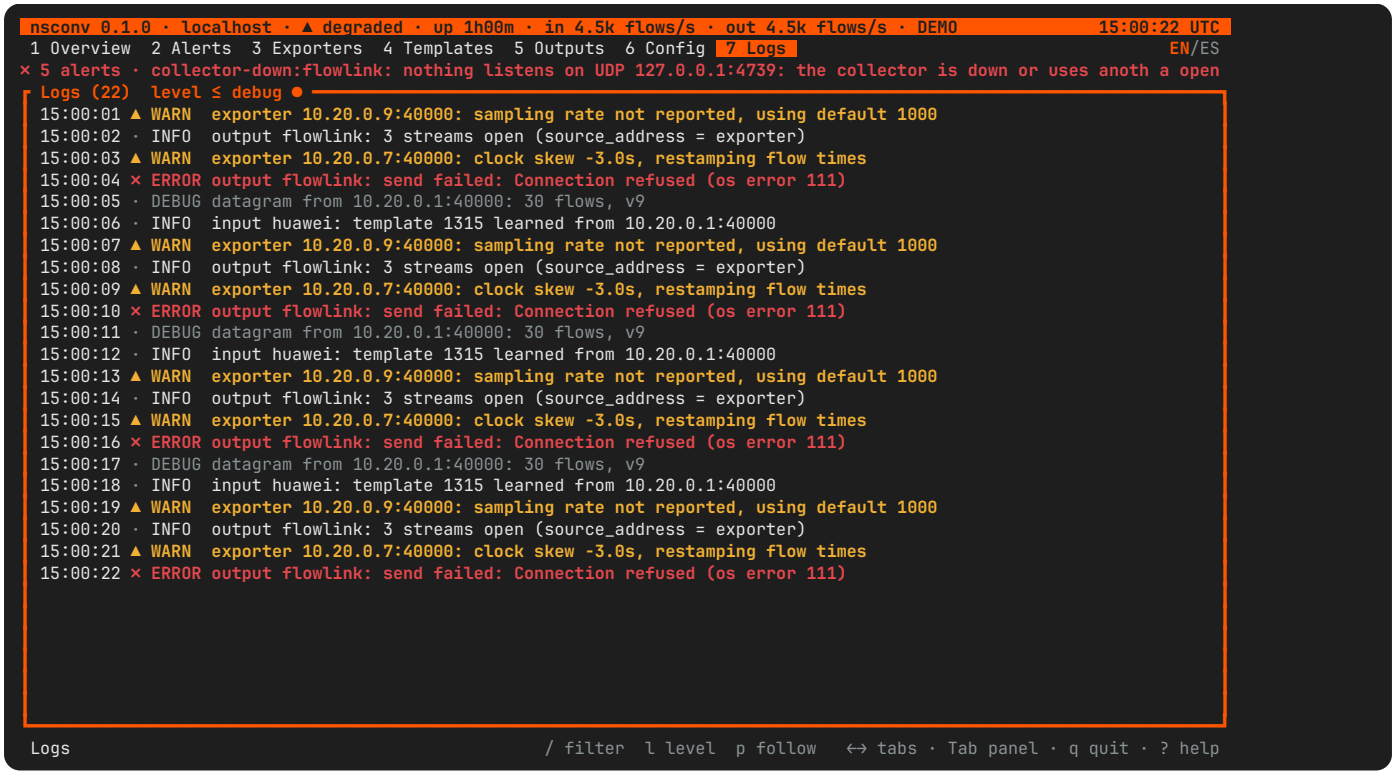
6 Config

Every key with its value. `Enter` edits the value, `Enter` again validates, writes the file (comments kept) and reloads; `Esc` cancels.



7 Logs

The service's recent log lines; `/` filters by text, `l` sets the minimum level.



Keys

KEYS	ACTION
`1` – `7` , `←` `→`	Switch tab
`Tab` , `↑` `↓` , `PgUp` `PgDn`	Move between panels and rows
`Enter` / `Esc`	Details or edit / close
`a` , `d` , `D` , `u`	Open Alerts, dismiss the selected alert, dismiss all, show again
`p` , `r` , `/`	Pause, reload the configuration, filter rows
`T` , `L`	Next theme, switch language
`?` , `q`	Help, quit

SOURCES

1. nsconv 0.1.0-rc1 — nsconvctl tui --demo — github.com/roschereric/netstream-converter

Troubleshooting by symptom

Start with `nsconvctl status`: health reasons, alerts and non-zero drop counters usually name the cause and the next step.

Nothing arrives (datagrams_in stays at 0)

- **Allow list.** A growing `denied` counter means the switch is not in `input.huawei.allow`; the journal names the denied source.
- **Firewall.** `firewall-cmd --zone=nsconv-exporters --list-all` must show the switch network as a source and `9996/udp` as a port.
- **Port.** The switch's export host line must name the port of `input.huawei.listen`. `ss -ulnp | grep 9996` shows that nsconv listens.
- **Reverse-path filter.** With `rp_filter = 1` (strict) the kernel drops packets that arrive on an interface that is not its route back to the source[1]. Check `sysctl net.ipv4.conf.all.rp_filter net.ipv4.conf.<interface>.rp_filter` (the higher value applies). With asymmetric routing, add a route to the switches via the receiving interface or use loose mode (2) on it.
- **Is anything on the wire?** `nsconvctl debug-capture 198.51.100.21` captures what reaches the host from that switch.

Data without template (no_template, alert no-template)

The switch sent data before nsconv had its template. Huawei refreshes templates every 30 minutes by default; set `template timeout-rate 1` on the switch. Learned templates survive nsconv restarts.

Sampling rate unknown (alert sampling-default)

The switch does not report its rate, so `input.huawei.sampling_rate` (default 1000) is used. If the switch samples at another rate, set it: `nsconvctl config set input.huawei.sampling_override '{ "198.51.100.21" = 2048 }'`. Use 1 for an unsampled switch.

Clock skew (restamped, alert restamped)

The switch clock differs from the host by more than `convert.max_clock_skew_secs` (300 s). nsconv shifts the flow times meanwhile. Fix NTP and the time zone on the switch; the SKEW column shows the measured difference.

FlowLink shows nothing

- **remote_addrs.** With `source_address = "exporter"` it must list the switch IPs; with `local` the nsconv address (or 127.0.0.1 on the same host). FlowLink discards flows from other sources.
- **Parser and port.** IPFIX output needs an `ipfix` consumer, NetFlow v9/v5 a `netflow` consumer, on the port of `output.<name>.target`.

- **Collector down.** The `collector-down` alert and the output's COLLECTOR column mean nothing listens on the target port on this host: start FlowLink or fix the port.
- **Just restarted.** After a FlowLink restart allow up to 20 seconds for the next template refresh.
- **Output failed: cannot open transparent sockets.** The service lacks `CAP_NET_RAW`, which the shipped unit grants. Restore the unit, or set `source_address = "local"`.
- **Standalone across routers with exporter.** Routers drop packets with the switch addresses as source; use `local`.

v5 and IPv6

NetFlow v5 has no IPv6. Switches with IPv6 traffic must export v9 (or IPFIX) with the `ipv6 netstream` lines, and an nsconv output with `protocol = "netflow5"` drops IPv6 flows (counter `v6_on_v5`). Use `ipfix` or `netflow9`.

Kernel drops at traffic peaks

A growing `kernel_drops` on an input (or `RcvbufErrors` in `grep ^Udp: /proc/net/snmp`) means the socket buffer filled up. Check that `sysctl net.core.rmem_max` is at least 8388608 and raise `input.huawei.recv_buffer_bytes` if needed (restart).

Service does not start: status 203/EXEC

SELinux label of a hand-copied binary: `restorecon -v /usr/local/bin/nsconvctl`. For other start errors, `journalctl -u nsconv` shows the reason; `nsconvctl config check` validates the file.

SOURCES

1. Linux kernel — IP sysctl (rp_filter) — docs.kernel.org/networking/ip-sysctl.html
2. FlowLink 2.0 — Troubleshooting — product-docs-repo.illumio.com/Tech-Docs/Core/26.1/Install-Upgrade-Admin/out/en/flowlink-2-0-0-configuration-and-usage/flowlink-usage/troubleshooting.html

Reference

The tables below are generated from the nsconv code and the shipped configuration of this release.

Commands

Global options: `--config PATH` (default `/etc/nsconv/nsconv.toml`), `--json`, `--no-color`, `-h` / `--help`, `-V` / `--version`. `nsconvctl <command> --help` lists each command's options.

COMMAND	WHAT IT DOES
`nsconvctl run`	Run the converter in the foreground (systemd ExecStart)
`nsconvctl status`	Health, counters, exporters and outputs of the running daemon
`nsconvctl dismiss`	Silence a warning shown by `status` (its id, or `all`); it returns if it doubles or after 24 h without it
`nsconvctl undismiss`	Show a dismissed warning again
`nsconvctl debug-capture`	Save the raw NetStream datagrams of one switch to a pcap for analysis (runs tcpdump, needs root)
`nsconvctl reload`	Validate the config file, then ask the daemon to reload it
`nsconvctl config`	Show, check or edit the config file
`nsconvctl logs`	Daemon log lines: journalctl -u nsconv, or --recent from the daemon's ring
`nsconvctl tui`	Full-screen terminal UI
`nsconvctl decode`	Decode a capture (or live datagrams) and print the normalized flows
`nsconvctl replay`	Send the NetFlow/IPFIX payloads of a capture to a collector (never spoofs the source)
`nsconvctl install`	Install the running binary, unit, user and default config (root; the RPM is the normal route)
`nsconvctl uninstall`	Remove what `install` added
`nsconvctl version`	Print the version

Configuration keys

`<name>` is the input or output name (`huawei`, `flowlink` in the shipped file). Defaults are those of the shipped file.

KEY	DEFAULT	MEANING
`version`	`1`	Schema version of the file. Only 1 is accepted.
`log.level`	`"info"`	error | warn | info | debug. Applied on reload.
`daemon.control_socket`	`"/run/nsconv/ctl.sock"`	Local control socket used by nsconvctl and the TUI. Restart to change.
`daemon.state_dir`	`"/var/lib/nsconv"`	Learned templates, alert dismissals and session history are kept here. Restart to change.
`convert.direction`	`"all"`	all | ingress | egress. With NetStream inbound and outbound on every port, transit traffic is reported twice; ingress keeps one copy.
`convert.max_clock_skew_secs`	`300`	If the exporter clock differs from this host by more than this, flow times are shifted to the receive time. 0 disables.
`convert.max_exporters`	`1024`	Maximum exporter sessions (switch IP, port and Source ID). New ones beyond it are refused and counted.
`convert.max_templates_per_exporter`	`32`	Maximum templates kept per exporter session.
`convert.max_fields_per_template`	`128`	Maximum fields per template (16 to 1024).
`convert.exporter_idle_secs`	`3600`	An exporter session without traffic for this long is removed; its totals stay in the history.
`input.<name>.name`	`"huawei"`	Input name (letters, digits, _ and -).
`input.<name>.listen`	`"0.0.0.0:9996"`	UDP address and port the switches send to. Never a FlowLink port. Use [::]:9996 for IPv6 too. Restart to change.
`input.<name>.allow`	`[]`	Switch IPs or CIDRs allowed to send. Empty = everything is dropped.
`input.<name>.sampling_rate`	`1000`	1-in-N rate used when a switch does not report one (flags the exporter and warns every 6 h).
`input.<name>.sampling_override`	`{}`	Per-switch rate that wins over everything the switch reports, e.g. { "198.51.100.21" = 2048 }.

KEY	DEFAULT	MEANING
`input.<name>.recv_buffer_bytes`	`4194304`	Socket receive buffer requested from the kernel (capped by net.core.rmem_max). Restart to change.
`output.<name>.name`	`"flowlink"`	Output name (letters, digits, _ and -).
`output.<name>.protocol`	`"ipfix"`	ipfix (recommended) | netflow9 | netflow5 (IPv4 only).
`output.<name>.target`	`"127.0.0.1:4739"`	Collector address and UDP port, e.g. the FlowLink consumer.
`output.<name>.source_address`	`"exporter"`	exporter = send from each switch's own IP and port (FlowLink remote_addrs = switch IPs); local = send from this host.
`output.<name>.observation_domain`	`1`	Observation Domain / Source ID, used only with source_address = local.
`output.<name>.template_refresh_secs`	`20`	Templates are resent this often (1 to 3600), so a restarted collector recovers quickly.
`output.<name>.max_datagram`	`1400`	Largest datagram sent, in bytes (512 to 9000).
`output.<name>.flush_ms`	`500`	A partly filled datagram is sent after this many milliseconds (10 to 10000).

Counters

Global counters in `nsconvctl status` (and `status --json`, object `counters`) count since the service started; per-exporter totals continue across restarts.

COUNTER	MEANING	WHAT TO DO
`datagrams_in`	Datagrams received on all inputs.	
`bytes_in`	Bytes received on all inputs.	
`flows_in`	Flows decoded from the switches.	
`flows_out`	Flows in datagrams sent successfully to the collectors.	
`datagrams_out`	Datagrams sent to the collectors.	
`denied`	Datagrams from a source that is not in the input's allow list.	Add the switch to input.<name>.allow.

COUNTER	MEANING	WHAT TO DO
`unsupported`	Datagrams that are not NetFlow v5, v9 or IPFIX (for example sFlow or NetFlow v8 aggregation).	Export v5, v9 or IPFIX on the switch.
`malformed`	Datagrams, sets or templates that cannot be parsed.	Check the path MTU; capture with debug-capture.
`no_template`	Data sets that arrived before their template.	Set template timeout-rate 1 on the switch, or wait for its refresh.
`no_tuple`	Records without IP addresses (Layer-2-only flows), unusable for Illumio.	Enable IP flow export on the switch.
`filtered`	Flows removed by convert.direction.	Change convert.direction if unexpected.
`exporter_limit`	Datagrams of new exporter sessions refused because convert.max_exporters was reached.	Raise convert.max_exporters.
`template_rejects`	Templates not stored because they exceed the size limits.	Raise convert.max_fields_per_template or max_templates_per_exporter.
`v6_on_v5`	IPv6 flows dropped by a NetFlow v5 output (v5 cannot carry IPv6).	Use protocol ipfix or netflow9.
`send_errors`	Datagrams that could not be sent, or outputs without a usable stream.	Check the output target and the collector.
`restamped`	Flows whose times were shifted because the switch clock is off.	Fix NTP and the time zone on the switch.
`sampling_defaulted`	Flows that used input.<name>.sampling_rate because the switch reports no rate.	Set input.<name>.sampling_override for that switch.
`datagrams_malformed`	Datagrams rejected as a whole (the first part of malformed).	As for malformed.
`datagrams_decoded`	Datagrams accepted and decoded.	
`truncated`	Data sets cut inside a record; the rest of that set is lost.	Switch bug or truncation; capture with debug-capture.
`sets_ignored`	Sets with a reserved id, skipped unread.	
`pkts_defaulted`	Flows without a packet counter (sent as 1).	Add packet counters to the switch record.
`bytes_defaulted`	Flows without a byte counter (sent as 0).	Add byte counters to the switch record.
`time_defaulted`	Flows without a start or end time (copied from the other, else the export time).	

COUNTER	MEANING	WHAT TO DO
`time_clamped`	Flows with end before start or a time before 1970, corrected.	Check the switch clock.
`values_clamped`	Values wider than their standard field, cut to its width.	
`flows_forwarded`	Flows handed to the outputs (after the direction filter).	
`flows_offered`	Flows given to outputs (forwarded × number of outputs).	
`encode_dropped`	Flows an encoder refused.	Raise output.<name>.max_datagram.
`flows_lost_output`	Flows lost because the output has no usable stream.	See the output's last error in status.
`flows_queued`	Flows written into output datagrams.	
`flows_lost_send`	Flows inside datagrams whose send failed.	Check the collector and the route.
`direction_unknown`	Flows without direction, exported as ingress.	
`time_wrapped`	v9/v5 times outside the 32-bit uptime window.	Use protocol ipfix.
`v5_saturated`	v5 counters above 2^32-1, saturated.	Use protocol ipfix or netflow9.
`v5_ifindex`	v5 interface index above 65535, sent as 0.	Use protocol ipfix or netflow9.
`v5_rate`	v5 sampling rate not carried exactly (one 14-bit rate per datagram).	Use protocol ipfix or netflow9.
`recv_errors`	Receive errors on an input socket.	Check the journal (open files, memory).
`seq_missing`	Export sequence numbers skipped (estimated loss between switch and nsconv).	Check the network path and kernel drops.
`seq_recovered`	Sequence numbers that arrived late (net loss = seq_missing − seq_recovered).	
`seq_reordered`	Datagrams that arrived out of order.	
`seq_resets`	Restarts of a switch's sequence numbering (reboot, line card).	
`control_errors`	Failed control-socket requests.	

COUNTER	MEANING	WHAT TO DO
`history_dropped`	Idle-session summaries dropped because the history is full.	
`kernel_drops (per input)`	Datagrams the kernel dropped because the socket buffer was full; they never reach datagrams_in.	Raise net.core.rmem_max and input.<name>.recv_buffer_bytes.

Exit codes

Every command except `run`, `tui` and `logs -f` ends with `NSCONV-RESULT schema=1 version=… command=… code=… status=…` (on stderr with `--json`).

CODE	STATUS	MEANING
`0`	`ok`	Success.
`1`	`warning`	Done with a warning, e.g. health degraded.
`2`	`failure`	Failed: daemon not running, invalid config, send error.
`3`	`failure`	Usage error: bad arguments, unreadable file.
`4`	`failure`	Permission denied: run as root or as a member of group nsconv.
`128+N`	—	Killed by signal N (e.g. 130 for Ctrl-C).

Files and paths

PATH	CONTENT
`/usr/bin/nsconvctl` (RPM), `/usr/local/bin/nsconvctl` (install)	Binary
`/usr/lib/systemd/system/nsconv.service` (RPM), `/etc/systemd/system/nsconv.service` (install)	systemd unit; user and group `nsconv`, only capability `CAP_NET_RAW`
`/etc/nsconv/nsconv.toml`	Configuration, root:nsconv 0640
`/var/lib/nsconv/templates.json`	Learned templates (written at most once per minute, only when they changed)
`/var/lib/nsconv/dismissed.json`, `history.json`	Dismissed alerts; summaries of idle exporter sessions
`/run/nsconv/ctl.sock`	Control socket, nsconv:nsconv 0660
`/usr/lib/sysctl.d/90-nsconv.conf`	`net.core.rmem_max = 8388608` (RPM)
`/usr/share/doc/nsconv/README.md`	Short README (RPM)
journal, unit `nsconv`	Logs (`journalctl -u nsconv`)

SOURCES

1. nsconv 0.1.0-rc1 — generated from the code of this release — github.com/roschereric/netstream-converter

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

This guide was prepared by Eric Roscher – Illumio Pre-Sales, LATAM to guide the installation, configuration and operation of nsconv with Illumio FlowLink. It is a working aid for the recipient and is not an official publication of Illumio, Inc.; it does not modify or replace official product documentation, contractual agreements, or statements of work. Validate all technical details against the official documentation for your specific product versions before acting on them. Illumio and the Illumio logo are trademarks of Illumio, Inc., used here to identify the subject matter.

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